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Beryllium hydroxide reacts with both acid and base as it is amphoteric in nature.

$Be(OH)_2 + HCl \rightarrow BeCl_2 + 2H_2O$

$Be(OH)_2 + 2\ NaOH \rightarrow Na_2BeO_2 + 2H_2O$

Activity 3.2

The electronegativity for some elements on pauling scale of different groups and periods are listed below. Plot these values against atomic number. From the pattern, explain the variation along a period and a group.

2^{nd} group elements : Be (1.6), Mg (1.2), Ca (1.0), Sr (1.0) Ba(0.9)

17^{th} group elements : F (4.0), Cl (3.0), Br (2.8), I (2.5)

3^{rd} Period elements : Na(0.9), Mg(1.2), Al (1.5), Si(1.8), P(2.1), S(2.5), Cl(3.0)

4^{th} period elements: K(0.8), Ca(1.0), Sc(1.3), Ti(1.5), V(1.6), Cr(1.6), Mn(1.5), Fe(1.8), Co(1.9), Ni(1.9), Cu(1.9), Zn(1.6), Ga(1.6), Ge(1.8), As(2.0), Se(2.4), Br(2.8)